# Module 3: Intellectual Property Protection

## Start here — Apple v. OpenAI

**Read before class (5–8 minutes):** the three facts and three terms below. The full blog, company summary, filing, and detailed role pages are optional depth unless a specific passage is assigned.

**In class:** review the worked example, explain the decision in your own words, then read only your assigned role in the student packet. Four leads make decisions; the Account Manager integrates them. The packet works without SkillSimm access.

### Three essential facts

- This packet analyzes allegations in a complaint, not findings of fact.
- The complaint describes both employee access and supplier relationships as possible routes for disclosure.
- The case asks teams to compare prevention, disclosure, and enforcement costs.

### Three terms

- Patent: protection that involves public disclosure and a defined legal claim.
- Trade secret: valuable information protected through reasonable secrecy measures.
- Appropriability: the ability to retain the benefits of an innovation.

### Worked example — discuss before opening the simulation

Illustrative startup: a food venture has a private recipe and a visible package design. Discuss which information must remain secret and what disclosure would change. State what you would need to research before choosing protection.

**Readiness check:** What asset are you protecting, and how would disclosure change its value? Ask a teammate to explain the task back before starting.

## What you produce

- **During the simulation:** one decision in words, one supporting figure or passage, one trade-off, and one condition that would change your mind.
- **Account Manager:** rank the four lead decisions 1–4 and allocate 100 priority points in blocks of 10; explain the first priority with evidence. These are priority weights, not course-grade points.
- **Before leaving:** save your individual decision record. If you finish early, start the venture workshop below.
- **After discussion:** submit your individual reflection through the existing HuskyCT assignment. See the reflection guide. Keep the current deadline; from October 20 onward, aim for 300–500 words.

## Thursday venture workshop — 15–20 minutes

Choose one asset in your venture. Compare two ways to protect it, identify a disclosure risk, and state what evidence would support your recommendation.

**Output:** A protection-choice table for Midterm Section D. Add it to your shared project document; this is preparation for the project, not a new separately graded assignment.

**Debrief question:** What did discussion change about your original decision? Explain the evidence, rather than reporting only an option letter.

**Takeaway:** Match the protection mechanism to the asset and distinguish allegations from established facts.

## Class rhythm

- **Tuesday (75 minutes):** 10 minutes concept and example; 5 minutes task walkthrough; 10 minutes role reading; 25 minutes decisions and team discussion; 15 minutes comparison; 10 minutes saving evidence and starting the venture application.
- **Thursday (75 minutes):** 10 minutes concept recap; 35 minutes selected role discussion and feedback; 20 minutes venture workshop; 10 minutes decision record and reflection questions.

Read instructions aloud slowly, pause after each step, and invite a student to restate what must be produced. Use the static packet and shared notes if the platform lags; resume the discussion without waiting on the tool.

## Access after class

The accompanying StudentPacket.html / .pdf and Debrief.html / .pdf can be opened without joining a simulation group. Save the packet and your own record before leaving. The same resources are linked from the deployed slide folder.